

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY



ATTACK REPORT

Agenda ransomware made its return with a Rust variant

Date of Publication

December 19, 2022

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2022303

Summary

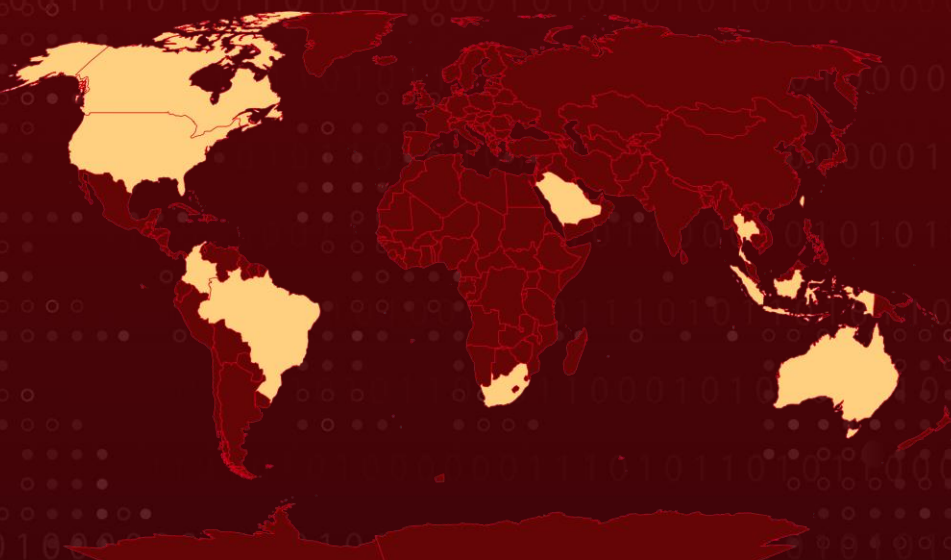
Active Since: August 2022

Attack Countries: Indonesia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, Colombia, Brazil, USA, Canada, Australia, Taiwan, and Thailand

Attack Industries: Telecommunication, Retail, Containers & Packaging, Automotive, Healthcare, and Education

Attack: Like its Go counterpart, Agenda's Rust variant targets vital industries.

🔪 Attack Regions



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Attack Details

#1

In addition to BlackCat, Hive, Luna, and RansomExx, Agenda is the latest ransomware strain to use the cross-platform programming language Rust. Ransomware-as-a-service (RaaS) group Agenda, attributed to an operator named Qilin, has been linked to a spate of attacks mainly targeting manufacturing and IT industries. The earlier version of the ransomware, which was written in Go and customized for each victim, targeted the education and healthcare sectors in Indonesia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, and Thailand.

#2

Like Royal ransomware, Agenda uses parameters to determine the amount of file content that is encrypted based on partial encryption (aka intermittent encryption). As soon as the encrypted files are ransomware-encrypted, they are given the extension "MmXReVlxLV," before a ransom note is dropped into every directory.

#3

Moreover, Agenda can terminate Windows AppInfo and disable User Account Control (UAC), both of which mitigate the impact of malware by requiring administrative access to run programs.

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

Potential **MITRE ATT&CK** TTPs

<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence	<u>TA0004</u> Privilege Escalation
<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0007</u> Discovery	<u>TA0040</u> Impact	<u>T1078</u> Valid Accounts
<u>T1078.002</u> Domain Accounts	<u>T1053</u> Scheduled Task/Job	<u>T1053.005</u> Scheduled Task	<u>T1547.001</u> Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder
<u>T1547</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	<u>T1562</u> Impair Defenses	<u>T1562.002</u> Disable Windows Event Logging	<u>T1562.009</u> Safe Mode Boot
<u>T1484</u> Domain Policy Modification	<u>T1484.001</u> Group Policy Modification	<u>T1055</u> Process Injection	<u>T1055.002</u> Portable Executable Injection
<u>T1046</u> Network Service Discovery	<u>T1486</u> Data Encrypted for Impact	<u>T1489</u> Service Stop	

Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	e90bdaaf5f9ca900133b699f18e4062562148169b29cb4eb37a0577388c22527 55e070a86b3ef2488d0e58f945f432aca494bfe65c9c4363d739649225efbbd1 37546b811e369547c8bd631fa4399730d3bdaff635e744d83632b74f44f56cf6
SHA1	e3496a341c96d77c0ef9bdeec333dd98e2215527 d34550ebc2bee47c708c8e048eb78881468e6bca a85d9d2a3913011cd282abc7d9711b2346c23899
MD5	6a93e618e467ed13f98819172e24fffa 334fd98ab462edc1274fecdb89fb0791 14dec91fdcaab96f51382a43adb84016

Recent Breaches

<https://www.lojastorra.com.br/>

<https://contempocard.com/>

<https://www.robertbernard.com/>

<https://www.dialog.com.au/>

<https://emtelco.com.co/>

<https://www.scinopharm.com.tw/>

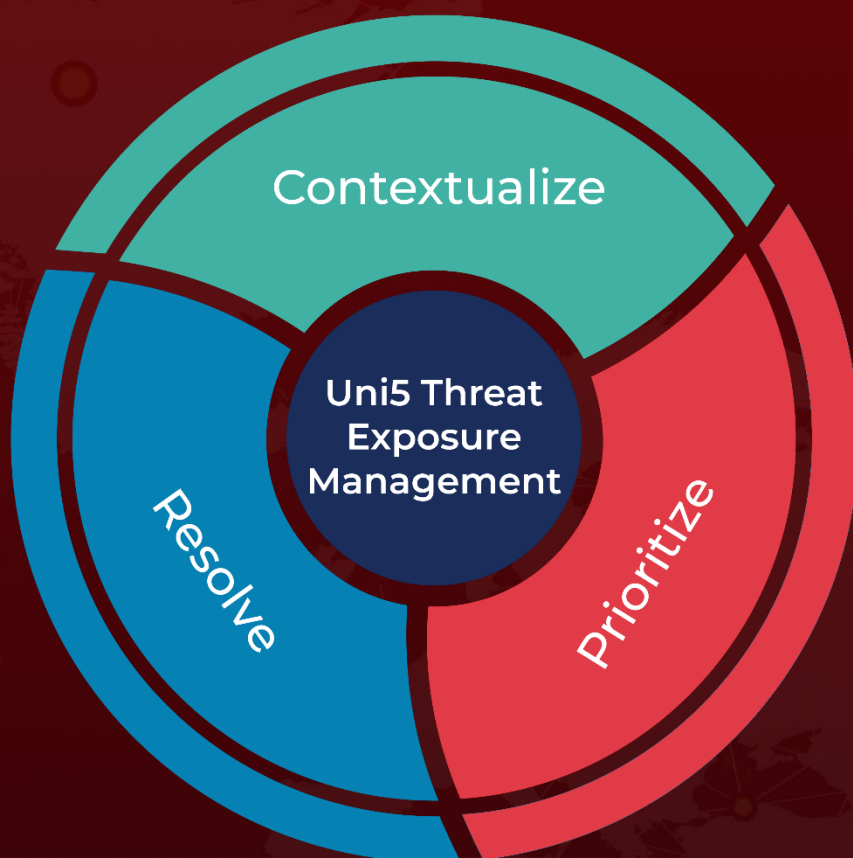
References

https://www.trendmicro.com/en_us/research/22/1/agenda-ransomware-uses-rust-to-target-more-vital-industries.html

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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